



MONTHLY UPDATE

Niger: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-29 • 32 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • DIGITALISATION • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA • GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

Two threads run through the window. The identity programme moved from card to travel document and from decree to build: [passport enrolment opened on 16 July](#), the [restructured WURI project was set out with its three statutory registers and its new agency](#), a technical mission went to Burkina Faso to study its identification stack, and in August the population register's awareness tour took the statutory texts to the regions, [officially launched at Dosso on 14 August](#).

The second is administrative consolidation onto state platforms: the [integrated human resources and payroll system was presented with its first digitisation figures](#), and [student grants are to be routed through the Treasury's own application](#).

Governance

Legislation and regulation

The civil-status regime rests on an [ordonnance of 22 April with its application decree of 18 May in force](#). No gazetted text of either is held.

Regional collaboration

On 30 July a Nigerien technical mission led by the interior ministry's secretary-general was [received in Ouagadougou to study Burkina Faso's identification machinery](#) — the civil-status modernisation directorate, the national identification office, the ICT agency and the WURI project. The delegation covered civil registration, migration, the digital agency, territorial surveillance, biometric-card production, the interior ministry's legal service and the ICT and finance ministries, and reported recommendations on issuing authentic documents and limiting document fraud.

Standards

On 27 July the regulator's verification campaign opened against the [mises en demeure served on all four mobile operators on 10 June 2026](#). Persistent breach exposes an operator to a fine of 1 to 3% of prior-year turnover, partial or total licence suspension, a shortened licence term, or definitive withdrawal by the Council of Ministers.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 27 July the telecommunications regulator [opened a second drive-test campaign over Niamey, running to 28 August 2026](#), to verify the corrective actions ordered after the April-May control found voice and mobile-data quality deficient at all four operators, with SMS alone compliant and one operator additionally below the 4G coverage thresholds.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

On 16 July the [president was the first enrollee for the AES biometric passport](#), a second phase after the identity card, in five categories — ordinary, service, diplomatic, refugee and Hadj — produced by the police security directorate with a Libyan supplier and a local partner; the [prime minister enrolled on 23 July](#).

On 27 July an account of the [restructured WURI-Niger project](#) set out the four instruments of April and May 2026 behind it — the civil-status ordonnance and its application décret, and the two décrets creating and chartering ANEI — and the three registers they establish, with population-register enrolment starting in Niamey's five arrondissements.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 29 July the higher education minister said the grants agency reform consists of [acquiring database software and routing scholarship and social-aid payments through the banking system via the Treasury's application](#); no budget, vendor, timetable or beneficiary count was published.

The mobile-money issuer opened cross-border corridors. It [launched an international transfer service on 25 August, taking inbound transfers from eight countries directly into the recipient's wallet through five remittance partners and sending outbound transfers to seven West African states](#); no volume or fee schedule is published.

Registries

Three differently based birth-registration series are now on record and none is reconciled to another. The [WURI-Niger account records that 66% of births are declared](#); the territorial administration ministry [put the figure at 79% against 53.48% in 2022](#) at the launch of the population register's enrolment tour and restated it [at Dosso on 14 August](#); and the same ministry [gave 80% in 2026 against 60% in 2023](#) at the African civil-registration day five days earlier.

That day also produced the first count of how far registration has been computerised: UNICEF's Tahoua office said it had [contributed to computerising 68% of communes nationwide](#), and put the Tahoua region's own registration rate up from 69% to 75%, with four communes still uncovered. It is UNICEF's account of its own contribution; no ministry count is held.

The register's public campaign ran through the window. It [opened at Tahoua on 11 August](#) to make the governing legal texts and the intermediate enrolment operations known, and was [launched officially at Dosso on 14 August](#), where the interior ministry set out the statutory basis — ordonnance n°2026-21 on the civil-status regime, décret n°2026-242 creating the ANEI and décret n°2026-243 approving its statutes — and described the register as a central secure database assigning each citizen a unique identifier, interoperable with civil-status management, the biometric national card and travel documents.

Also on 29 July, the Diffa regional civil-status directorate reported [173,109 birth certificates issued between July 2023 and July 2026](#), of which 109,382 were timely declarations, with the timely rate rising from 56% in 2022 to 88.04% in 2025.

On 29 July the foreign minister closed the second diaspora forum by [undertaking to build a bank of priority diaspora projects and a data bank of diaspora experts](#); no enabling instrument, custodian, data-protection basis or timetable was named.

The population register's public campaign is running ahead of the register itself. A national civil-status and identification sensitisation tour [reached Tillabéri as its third region](#), with officials citing the 2026 civil-status ordinance and describing a forthcoming national population register whose first enrolment phase opens at Niamey ahead of a 2027 rollout to other regions. No enrolment target, budget, supplier or start date accompanies it, so the campaign precedes anything a citizen can yet enrol in.

Sectoral management information systems

On 9 July the health ministry [validated the roadmap of the national e-health master plan 2025-2029](#), covering 27 structuring projects across health information, interoperability, epidemiological surveillance and cybersecurity.

On 27 July the public service minister [presented the integrated state human resources and payroll system](#) to the consultative council: a scope of about 200,000 public agents and at least 150 payroll managers, a biometric database against double enrolment, career events cascading into pay, and 16,500 agent files digitised and 23,000 updated so far.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

On 15 July the tax directorate [convened a national seminar on digitalising the tax administration](#), its core systems back at full operation after sanctions, with recommendations sought toward a round-the-clock digital tax service.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

On 10 July the digital agency's [Villages Intelligents programme opened a digital centre at Tabelot in Agadez](#), with training for women and girls.

Technology

ICT Industry

Hardware assembly is the one industrial position with a date attached. A government delegation inspecting the electronics plant at Hamdallaye [put it at 63 per cent complete and due in service by the end of October 2026, to assemble smartphones, computers and tablets](#). A completion percentage and a month are more than most rows in this report carry; what is absent is everything downstream of the building — capacity, cost, ownership and who buys the output.

Innovation ecosystem

The innovation estate gained a site and not yet a hub. A university at Diffa [was selected through a competitive process to host an innovation hub under a development-bank and UN-backed youth agripreneurship programme, and the workshop validating its project document opened](#). A project document at validation is the stage before a budget: none is published, and no opening date is set.

Capacity

Training and skills

Skills work in the window travelled rather than sat still. The Niger Digital Day caravan [opened its Maradi stage as a two-day youth digital-skills programme its organisers say will run in all eight regions and reach more than 800 young people, with training including artificial intelligence](#). Coverage and reach are the organisers' own figures and no per-stage completion count is published, so the caravan is on record as a plan being executed rather than as a measured outcome.

Research institutions

The [Council of Ministers of 21 August 2026 took decisions on research and innovation](#). Cabinet conclusions name what is decided without carrying the text of it, so the base holds the announcement and not the instruments.

Inclusion

Access to services

On 15 July the World Food Programme [inaugurated the Guidan Fasaha community digital centre at Tahoua](#), the second such centre after Diffa, with 100 computers and 50 kW of solar power, funded by Luxembourg and aimed at young people, women and displaced people.

Digital divides

One training cohort is the whole of the window's movement here. [500 women working in agri-food processing and pottery at Zinder completed a ten-day programme in business management, financial planning and the use of digital financial tools, run by a mobile operator's foundation as part of an effort it is extending across several countries](#). What is established is a completed cohort, not any change in the women's access to financial services: no follow-up, account-opening figure, cost or continuation is published.

Data

National statistics

Traditional chiefs at Diffa were [trained as mobilisers for the fifth population and housing census](#).

Use of satellite data

The national geographic institute [runs a remote-sensing unit producing Sentinel-based imagery for forest, land-use and territorial monitoring, and describes itself as an exclusive satellite-imagery distributor in several countries](#). No programme name, partner or date is published, and the page carries no date of its own, so the position is dated to retrieval rather than to any event.

Geopolitics

China activities

China's newly arrived ambassador [met the vendor's vice-president to discuss deepening cooperation](#). The vendor has operated in Niger since 1998 and a [2014 export-credit loan of RMB 623.7m built a 2,275 km domestic fibre backbone completed in 2017](#); no Chinese financing or vendor contract after 2017 is on record.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-29
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/NER/NER-monthly.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/NER/NER-monthly-2026-08-29.pdf
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